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A practical guide to Application Control for business

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Speakers

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Kim Oppalfens

AppControl.AI Founder

Kim.Oppalfens@oscc.be

20 Years MVP Endpoint mgmt

As passionate about App Control as James is about OpenIntune Baseline

@TheWmiGuy

Speakers

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Tom Degreef

AppControl.AI Founder

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MVP Endpoint Mgmt Alumni

@TomDegreef

https://github.com/kimoppalfens/PublicSpeaking

Agenda

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Part 1

- Benefits
- Different starting Policies
- A word on Policy Types
- Intune as the managed installer & ISG
- Path rules

Agenda

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Part 2

- Handling Packaged Apps
- Security Catalogs
- AppControl.AI
- Training
- Q&A

Benefits

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Zero DfE identified threats affect Windows Workstations

Only 6 threats out of 100 affect Windows Server

0 Attack Campaign are effective on Server or Workstation OS

Completely Script based attacks are responsible for 11 threats (9 campaigns)

Fully DLL based attacks are responsible for another 11 threats (4 campaigns)

The different starting policies

- **Corporate Base policy**
  - Supplemental Corporate signing policy
  - Supplemental Packaged apps also known as store apps policy
  - Optional: Supplemental Pathrule policy
- **Security catalogs for applications & Backlog**
- **Recommended block rule Base policy**

The Policy Options : Getting started edition

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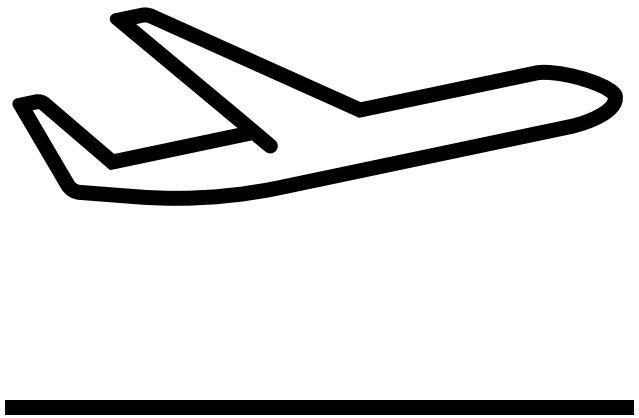

Use the same Policy options across your base policies

- 0 - Enabled:UMCI
- 3 - Enabled:Audit Mode
- **4 – Prevent “Flighted” builds (EG: Windows insider)**
- 6 - Enabled:Unsigned System Integrity Policy
- 9 - Enabled:Advanced Boot Options Menu
- **12 – Required: Enforce Store Applications**
- **13 – Managed installer**
- 16 - Enabled:Update Policy No Reboot
- 17 – Enabled: Allow supplemental policies

Managed Installer

- Allow apps installed by your App Deployment Solution*
  (*assuming they were installed after the managed installer was defined.)
- Limitations
  - Modifying files trusted based on Managed Installer extended attributes invalidates the trust
    - EG: Self-updating apps become untrusted after an update
  - Broken Process Trees
    - Windows Installer Custom Actions (WIX)

Enabling the Managed Installer

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Home > Endpoint security

Endpoint security | App Control for Business

Search

- Favorites
  - App Control for Business
- Overview
  - Overview
  - All devices
  - Security baselines
  - Security tasks
- Manage
  - Antivirus
  - Disk encryption
  - Firewall
  - Endpoint Privilege Management
  - Endpoint detection and response
  - App Control for Business

Policies | **Managed installer**

To begin configuring the Intune Management Extension as a Managed Installer on all applicable enrolled devices in the tenant, select "Create". You can review the status of the policy in your tenant, and the number of devices where the policy succeeded or resulted in an error.Learn more about how Intune sets the managed installer.

Create | Refresh | Export | Columns

2 items

Policy name	Author	Status	Succeeded	Error	Last modified
Group based Deployment	Microsoft Corp	Active	2	0	09/23/2025, 03:36 PM
SideCar ManagedInstaller Script	Microsoft	Active	15	0	08/25/2025, 08:29 PM

Intelligent Security Graph

- Authorize Reputable Apps
- Geared towards organizations without Centralized software distribution capabilities
- Reputable != excluded from Malicious use
- Challenges
  - Python
  - Teamviewer
  - PSTools
  - Putty

Demo: Create the Corporate Base policy

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App Control Policy Wizard

Home

Policy Creator

Policy Type

Policy Template

Policy Rules

File Rules

Creating Policy

Settings

Configure Policy Template

Policy Rules

The policy rules are pre-set based on the template you have chosen.

Learn more about policy options

- Advanced Options

Advanced Boot Options Menu	ON	Managed Installer	ON	Boot Audit on Failure	OFF
Allow Supplemental Policies	ON	Require WHQL	OFF	Disable Flight Signing	ON
Disable Script Enforcement	OFF	Update Policy without Rebooting	ON	Disable Runtime Filepath Rules	OFF
Enforce Store Applications	ON	Unsigned System Integrity Policy	ON	Dynamic Code Security	OFF
Hypervisor-protected Code Integrity	ON	User Mode Code Integrity	ON	Invalidate EAs on Reboot	OFF
Intelligent Security Graph	OFF	Treat Revoked as Unsigned	OFF	Require EV Signers	OFF

Do you want to run this policy in audit mode?

Turning audit mode on will not enforce the policy. We recommend first running policy in Audit Mode prior to enforcement.

Audit Mode ON

It is recommended to run new policies in audit mode before enforcement to determine the impacts of the policy.

Next

Demo: Recommended block rules

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App Control Policy Wizard

- Home
- Policy Creator
- Policy Type
- Policy Template
- Policy Rules
- File Rules
- Creating Policy
- Settings

File Rules

Create allow or deny rules for files based on publisher, path, file attributes or hash values.

Policy Signing Rules List

+ Add Custom Rule

Action	Level	Name	Associated Files
Allow	Publisher	MincryptKnownRootMicrosoftTestRoot2010	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root 2010 Windows EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root 2010 ELAM EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root 2010 HAL EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root 2010 WHQL EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root WHQL EKU SHA1	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root WHQL EKU MD5	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 Windows EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 ELAM EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 HAL EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 WHQL EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft MarketPlace PCA 2011	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 Store EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Product Root 2010 RT EKU	
Allow	Publisher	MincryptKnownRootMicrosoftDMDRoot2005	
Allow	Publisher	MincryptKnownRootMicrosoftProductRoot2010	
Allow	Publisher	MincryptKnownRootMicrosoftStandardRoot2011	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Flighting Root 2014 RT EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Standard Root 2011 RT EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Standard Root 2011 Enclave EKU	
Allow	Publisher	Microsoft Code Signing PCA 2011	CN = Microsoft Corporation; ID_FILEATTRIB_REFRESH
Allow	Publisher	MincryptKnownRootMicrosoftTestRoot2010	
Allow	FileAttributes	Original Filename: *	
Allow	FileAttributes	Original Filename: *	

☑ Merge with Recommended User Mode Block Rules

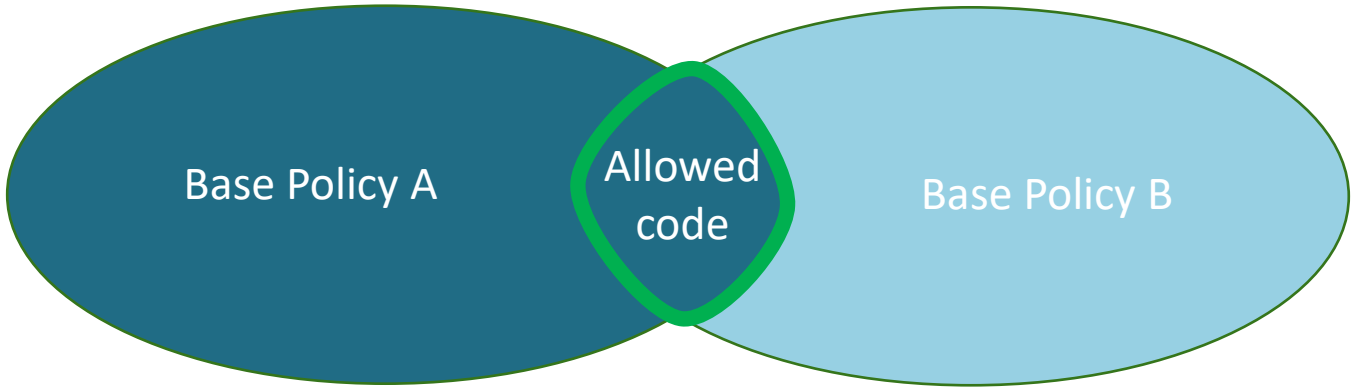
☐ Merge with Recommended Kernel Block Rules

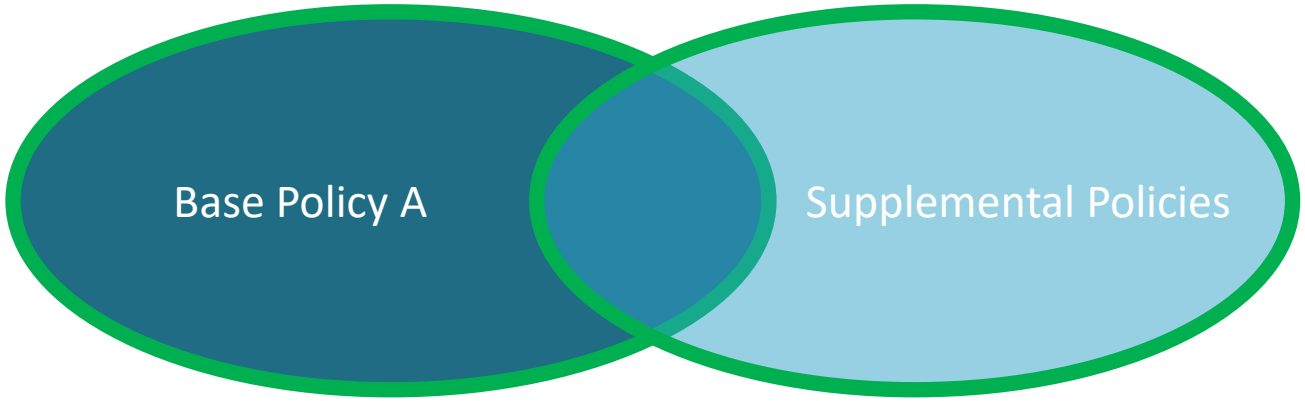
- Remove Rule

Next

A word on policy types

Allowed Code marked in green thick line





Supplemenal policies can only expand the trust scope so Deny rules can't be in Supplemental policies

Supplemental Corporate signing policy

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```
$cert = New-SelfSignedCertificate -Type CodeSigningCert -Subject 'Application control signing cert' -CertStoreLocation Cert:\CurrentUser\my
```

```
Export-Certificate -Cert $cert -filepath appcontrolcert.cer
```

Or

Public / Corporate issued cert

Create supplemental policy by browsing to .Cer file

Corporate Signing Policy

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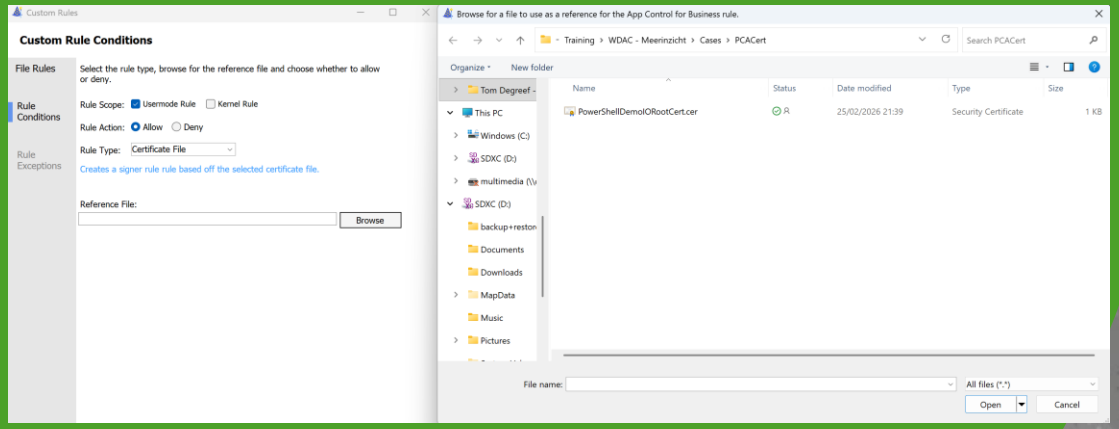
Use the WDAC Wizard to trust a code-signing certificate.



Handling Packaged Apps

- **Default Application Control policy trusts all store apps**
  - Based on Enhanced Key Usage property on store signing cert that is part of the Default policy
- **Create Package Family name based roles to effectively manage store apps**
- **Challenges**
  - Python, PSTools, Teamviewer, yet again
  - Electron Apps bypass as discovered by the IBM Red team

PFN Demo

Create the supplemental PFN based packaged app policy using PowerShell

```
# Create packaged app policy
Get-AppxPackage | Out-GridView -PassThru | %{$Rules += New-CIPolicyRule -Package $_}
New-CIPolicy -Rules $rules -FilePath .\packagedapppolicy.xml -MultiplePolicyFormat -UserPEs
Set-CIPolicyIdInfo -BasePolicyToSupplementPath "basepolicy.xml" -FilePath .\packagedapppolicy.xml
```

The Path rules

No Windows* Path Rule needed

- OS Binaries are trusted by the Default policy and digitally signing
  - Applies to Classic Teams, Intune, Defender for Endpoint Agent, Onedrive & Edge too

C:\Windows\Assembly*

- Dotnet Native images (Performance penalty + Log Pollution)

C:\Windows\Installer*

- Increase managed installer success for MSI Custom actions

(Program files* & Program files (x86)*)

Path rules demo

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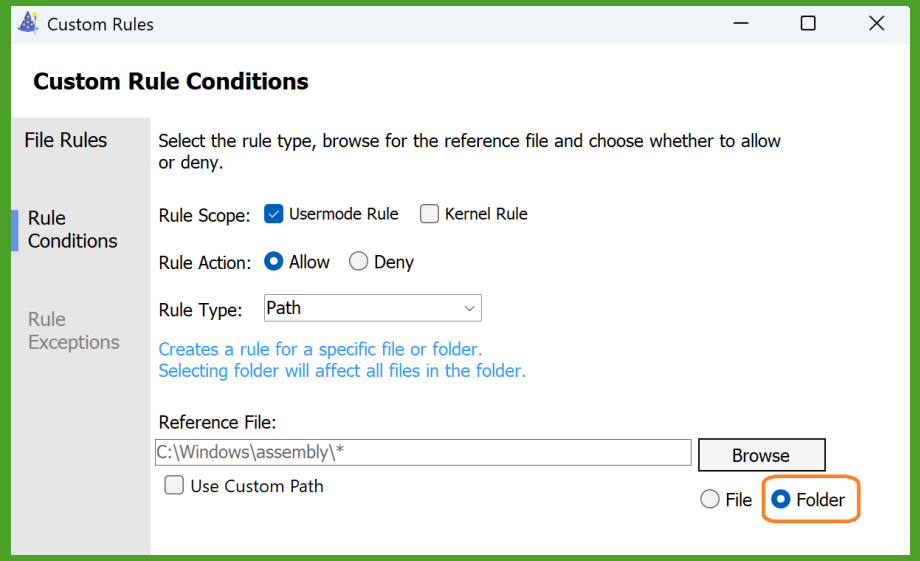
Create the path rules supplemental policy



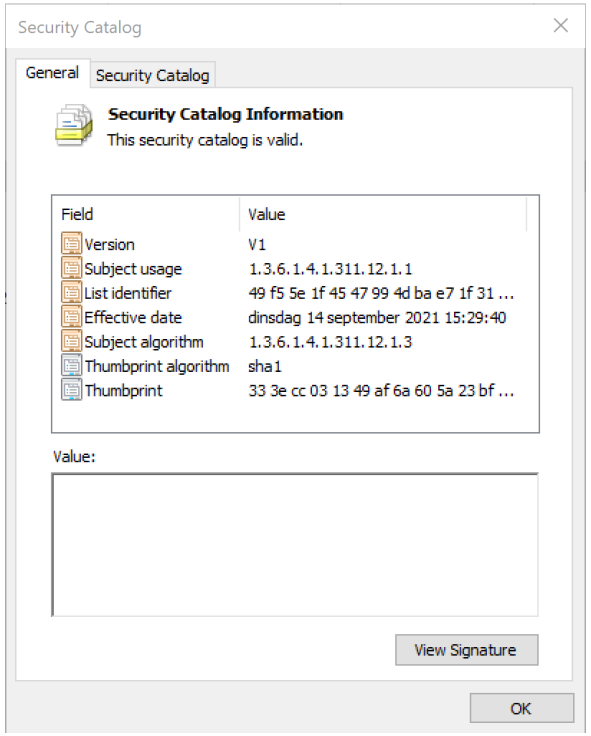
Security catalog basics

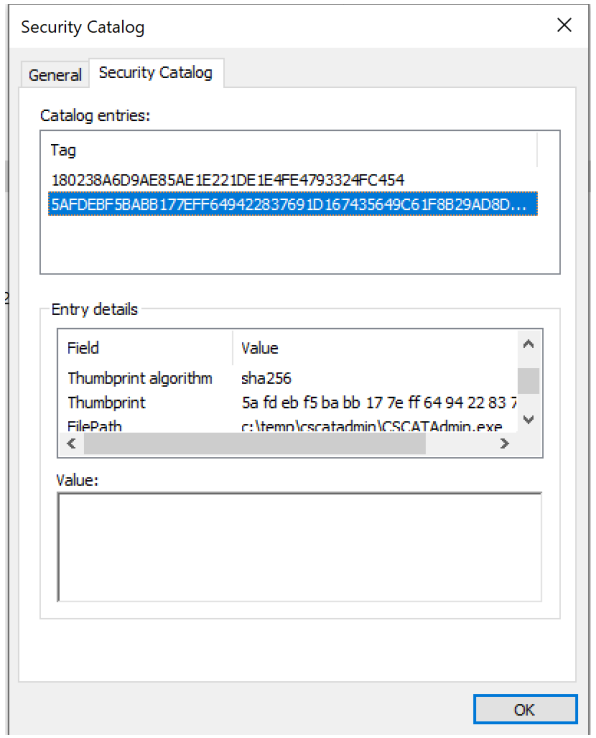
.cat files, Introduced 2 decades ago with Windows 2000

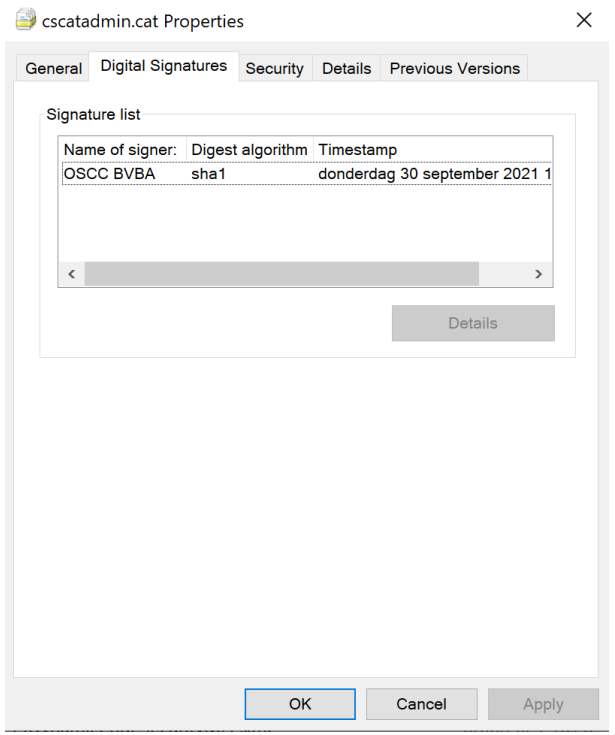
Enforcement started in Windows XP

- Driver signing is Kernel Mode Code Integrity

Windows Defender Application Control adds User mode Code Integrity







Catalog use cases

Catalogs can make apps trusted without modifying your CodeIntegrity policy!

Catalogs are great for

- Managebility
- Unsigned binaries
- Non-Greenfield scenarios / Managed Installer backlog
- ConfigMgr Tasksequence installed applications
- Quick go-to market applications
  - Repeatable procedure
- Tight / manageable control
- Application Control automation

https://www.appcontrol.ai/post/why-security-catalogs-are-so-great

WWW.AppControl.AI

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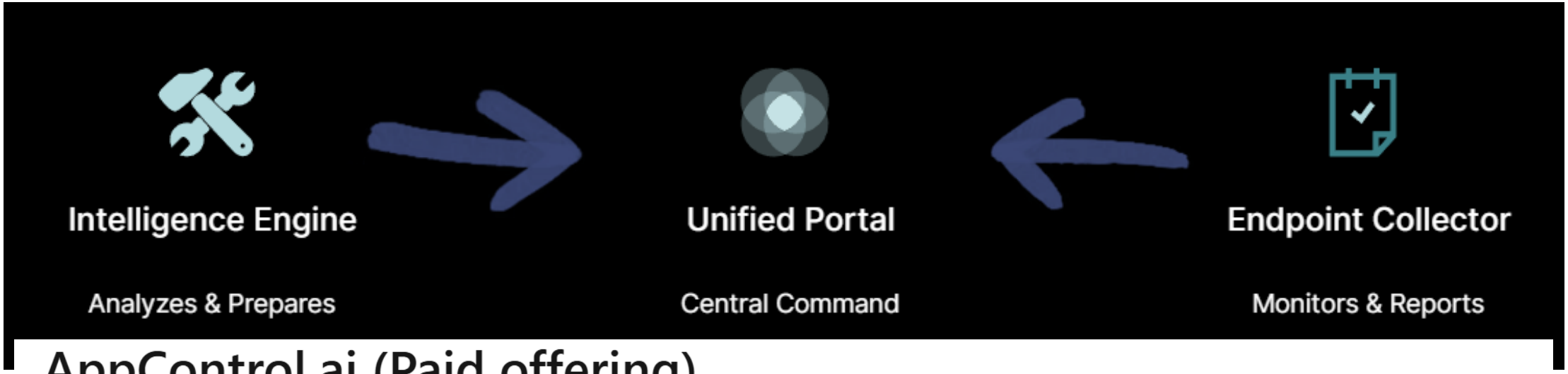
AppControl.ai has been listed as the Enterprise solution for implementing Microsoft's application control
Select tools to manage App Control for Business | Microsoft Learn



AppControl.ai (Paid offering)

Founders: Tom Degreef and Kim Oppalfens **Technical Lead:** Kim Oppalfens (Microsoft MVP – Windows Security & Enterprise Manageability) **Availability:** AppControl.ai is a commercial SaaS and consulting services solution. Request a demo, create an account, or get assistance from their company website.

Training opportunity!

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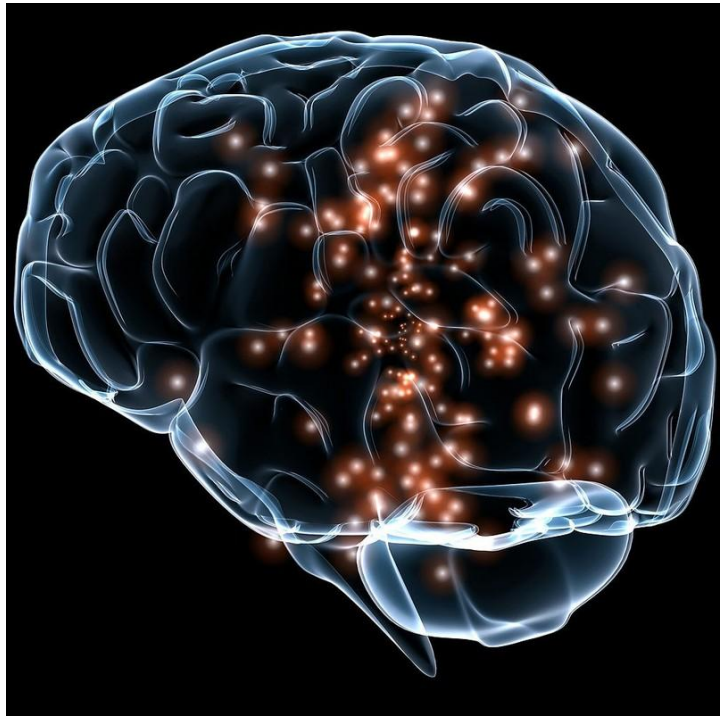
Tuesday 12 May 2026 – 16:00-19:30

Thursday 14 May 2026 – 16:00-19:30

Tuesday 19 May 2026 – 16:00-19:30

Thursday 21 May 2026 – 16:00-19:30

Tuesday 26 May 2026 – 16:00-19:30



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Great Session!

Okay Session!

Not so okay Session!

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